and religious charity. It started publishing its magazines *Al-Qalam* and *Muslim Ummah* openly,[2] which were available both online and on newsstands. These publications made appeals for donations for causes like building mosques or providing relief during natural calamities. ART claimed to have taken up the responsibility of monthly funding for approximately 850 homes of the martyrs and the comrades imprisoned in India and other countries.

According to ART's online magazine *Al-Qalam*, the group had built 13 mosques and 24 more were under construction until 2010. The group also called on people to donate for social services, support the households of martyrs and mujahedeen, sponsor Islamic preaching and struggle for the release of Muslim captives, among other causes. ART was sanctioned by the US Department of the Treasury on 4 November 2010 as a front organisation for JeM, which was declared as a foreign terrorist organisation by the US Department of State in 2001 and 2008.

Both JeM and ART maintained discreet relationships with Al Qaeda, by providing manpower to help Al Qaeda in urban centres.[3] It also had links with Rashid Rauf (the transatlantic airline bomb plot) and Sheikh Ahmed Omar (the Daniel Pearl case). In 2009, five American youths who were trying to join either JeM or LeT were detained in the Sargodha district of Punjab Province (*Dawn*, 2009).

Masood Azhar's speeches and Friday sermons were often related to topics such as atrocities perpetrated against Muslims in the West and India. Known for giving fiery anti-Western and anti-Indian tirades in the style of Jama'at ud-Da'wah Amir Hafiz Saeed, Masood Azhar and his Al-Rahamat Trust worked hard to revive Pakistan's madrasahs as places to recruit and indoctrinate a new generation of Islamic militants.

JeM was one of several jihadi organisations that formed the Muttahida Jihad Council (MJC) in Pakistan in order to battle Indian troops in Kashmir.

Maulana Masood Azhar was born in Bahawalpur, Punjab, in 1968 in a religious family. He joined a famous Madrasah Jamia Binoria in Karachi, where he studied from 1980 to 1989. He taught in the same institution for the next two years (Hussain, 2007). The madrasah was a well-known institution due to its historical role in the Deobandi Movement and produced radical Islamists who later became part of Afghan jihad against the soviet forces. Azhar became part of young fighters from his madrasah who were travelling to Afghanistan to fight against the Soviet forces in